

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do you have to add bottled lemon juice or citric acid when canning tomatoes?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To make sure the tomatoes are acidic enough to be safe from bacteria

FUN FACT

Tomatoes alone are sometimes not acidic enough to be safely canned!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the right amount of bottled lemon juice to add to a pint jar of tomatoes when canning?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

1 tablespoon

FUN FACT

Lemon juice helps keep canned tomatoes safe and yummy!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What happens if you don't follow tested salsa recipes when canning?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Your salsa might not be safe to eat and could cause sickness

FUN FACT

Safe recipes have been tested in labs to stop harmful germs!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you never change the amounts of ingredients in a tested salsa recipe?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because it can make the salsa unsafe by changing how well it preserves

FUN FACT

Even small changes in ingredients can affect safety when canning salsa.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is one reason to wear gloves when handling hot peppers for salsa?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To keep the pepper oils from burning your skin or eyes

FUN FACT

Hot pepper oils can irritate your skin and eyes a lot!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to remove air bubbles before sealing jars of canned salsa?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To help the jars seal safely and keep the salsa fresh

FUN FACT

Air bubbles can cause jars not to seal right and let germs in!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

If you use a boiling water canner, how long should you process jars of salsa at low altitude (0-1,000 ft)?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

15 minutes

FUN FACT

Processing time keeps bacteria from growing inside your salsa jars!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What should you do immediately after boiling tomatoes to prepare them for canning?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Dip them in cold water and slip off their skins

FUN FACT

Boiling helps loosen tomato skins so you can peel them easily!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do canned tomato recipes often say to leave 1/2 inch headspace in the jar?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

So the food can expand safely when heated during processing

FUN FACT

Headspace helps prevent jars from breaking or leaking while canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Which of these is NOT safe to increase in spaghetti sauce recipes when canning?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Onions or celery

FUN FACT

Too many onions or celery can change acidity and might make the sauce unsafe!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What type of tomatoes can you use for canning salsa or sauces?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Any kind, including heirloom or green tomatoes

FUN FACT

All kinds of tomatoes work for canning if prepared safely!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you avoid using overripe or frost-damaged tomatoes for canning?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because they can make your canned product unsafe or of poor quality

FUN FACT

Bad tomatoes can spoil your whole batch of canned food!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the safest way to peel hot peppers for salsa recipes?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Place peppers under a broiler or on a hot burner to blister skins, then peel

FUN FACT

Blistering the skins makes them easy to peel without losing flavor!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the correct way to prepare salsa before filling jars for canning?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Heat the salsa to boiling and simmer it as the recipe directs

FUN FACT

Heating salsa helps kill germs before sealing it in jars!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why must you wipe jar rims before placing the lid on?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To remove food bits that might stop the jar from sealing properly

FUN FACT

Clean jar rims help your lid stick tight and keep canned food safe!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What can you use instead of bottled lemon juice to add acid to canned tomatoes?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Bottled lime juice

FUN FACT

Key lime juice is not recommended because its acidity is different.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

When canning salsa, why should hot peppers be seeded and chopped carefully?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To control the heat and make it safer to eat

FUN FACT

Removing seeds can reduce some spiciness but keep flavor strong!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is one reason to use a pressure canner instead of a boiling water canner when canning tomatoes with meat?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because meat needs higher heat to kill germs safely

FUN FACT

Pressure canners reach higher temperatures to safely preserve low-acid foods like meat.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What should you do with jars of canned tomatoes after processing and removing from the canner?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Let them cool undisturbed for 12 to 24 hours before checking seals

FUN FACT

Cooling lets jars finish sealing properly to keep food safe!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why does adding vinegar to some salsa recipes change the flavor?

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because vinegar adds a sour taste that can be strong

FUN FACT

Vinegar helps preserve salsa but can make it tangier than lemon juice.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables